

— A NEW SERIES

You're not crazy. What you're living through *has a name.*

Workplace bullying, narcissistic tactics, and the systems that let them work. Written by someone still inside one.

THE VOCABULARY NOBODY GAVE YOU

01 / 10 →

WHO'S TALKING

I'm the youngest of nine.

My closest sibling is eight years older than me. In a narcissistic family, I was the scapegoat: the least believed, and the one most trained to doubt my own memory.

I spent years healing. Things got better **everywhere**.

Except one place. Work.



When your life heals everywhere but one room, the harm isn't coming from you.

It's coming from the room.

— NAME IT

01

Gaslighting

Making someone doubt their own memory or perception.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

“That never happened.”

“You're being too sensitive.”

Where the term comes from: Common term, from the 1938 play *Gas Light*.

— NAME IT

02

DARVO

Deny, **A**ttack, **R**everse **V**ictim and **O**ffender. You report harm and end up being the one investigated.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

“I'm the one who feels attacked here.”

Where the term comes from: Research term, Jennifer Freyd, 1997.

— NAME IT

03

Credibility laundering

Damaging someone's reputation in advance, so that when they finally report something, nobody believes them.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

A story about you that reaches the room before you do.

Where the term comes from: From my working vocabulary.

NAME IT

04

Flying monkeys

People who do a bully's work for them: repeating the story, keeping watch, reporting back.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

“Everyone has noticed.”

“I'm just telling you what people are saying.”

Where the term comes from: Popular-psychology term.

— NAME IT

05

The double bind

Every option you have counts against you.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

Speak up and you're “difficult.” Stay quiet and you're “disengaged.”

Where the term comes from: Research term, Bateson and colleagues, 1956.

Naming it takes some of its power away.

In Jennifer Freyd's research, people who had **learned how DARVO works** were less swayed by it. They believed the victim more and blamed them less.

A tactic with a name is harder to use.

Source: Harsey & Freyd (2020), summarized at jjfreyd.com/darvo



ON SUBSTACK NOW

Part 1: Healing Everywhere But Work

The full story, with more detail than fits on a slide.

Link in bio. Save this post, and send it to someone who needs to hear they're not crazy.